



Advanced Micro Devices

AMD's Gigahertz Equivalency: Inexperienced Buyers Accept Bad Science

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This White Paper focuses on Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) and details how the company is taking a step down a slippery slope of bad science. Specifically, AMD is naming its Athlon XP line of microprocessor models using clock-speed gigahertz ratings equivalent to Intel's competing Pentium 4 - based on a set of application benchmarks. Aberdeen's research suggests that AMD's processor equivalency methodology is seriously flawed: It assumes a specific application usage model that does not apply to many users; it is platform-specific, ignoring critical differences such as memory type; and it is inconsistent between mobile and desktop processors. Moreover, the methodology uses system-level benchmarks including Input/Output, an approach that is not used by the industry to measure processors alone.

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